# The Fitzmaurice Family

*Genealogy & Historical Photo Analysis*

*A forensic examination of 12 items spanning c.1865–1952*

*Connecting the Fitzmaurice family to the Earldom of Orkney*

*Edith Madeleine Fitzmaurice, c.1899*

*Edward Dixon Fitzmaurice, Clergyman (Stuart, Knightsbridge)*

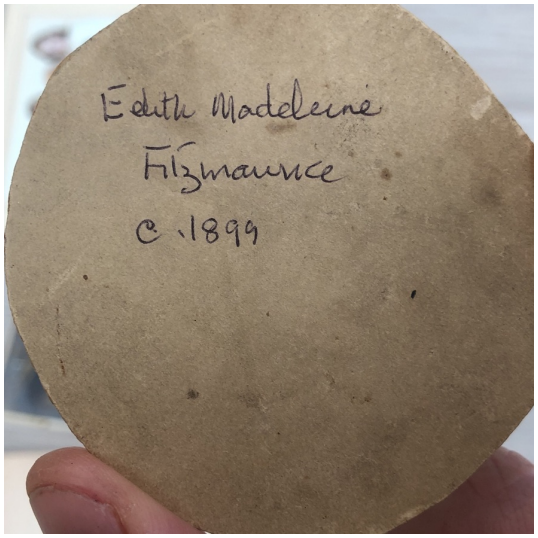
## COLLECTION OVERVIEW

This collection of 12 items spans approximately **1865–1952** and comprises cabinet cards, cartes de visite, snapshot photographs, and newspaper clippings. A single aristocratic English family — the **Fitzmaurices** — threads through the entire collection, with verifiable connections to the **Earldom of Orkney**. Multiple London photographers are represented, placing the family firmly in Victorian and Edwardian London. The collection is unusually well-labelled, with handwritten names on several items providing primary genealogical evidence.

*Overview of the collection as photographed — a century of Fitzmaurice family life.*

## ITEMS 1 & 2 — Circular Medallion Photograph

*"Edith Madeleine Fitzmaurice, c.1899"*




*Back — handwritten inscription: 'Edith Madeleine Fitzmaurice / c.1899'*

*Front — formal portrait of Edith Madeleine Fitzmaurice*

### 1. Image Overview

A circular format photograph, front and back. The back bears a handwritten inscription in period ink: *"Edith Madeleine Fitzmaurice / c.1899."* The front shows a full-length studio portrait of a young woman in formal Victorian dress, holding a large floral bouquet. The circular cardboard substrate suggests a **photographic miniature or medallion print** — an uncommon but documented Victorian format, often used as keepsake gifts or memorial items.

### 2. Person Analysis — Edith Madeleine Fitzmaurice

| Feature | Observation |
|---|---|
| Estimated Age | Late teens to mid-20s (implies birth c.1875–1880) |
| Build | Slim, upright Victorian posture |
| Dress | Full-length light formal gown, structured bodice, puffed sleeves, floor-length skirt |
| Hair | Dark, pinned up with ornamental headpiece or floral accessory |
| Jewellery | Pearl or bead necklace visible |
| Accessories | Large floral bouquet held at left arm |
| Occasion | Formal — consistent with debut, engagement, or special occasion portrait |

### 3. Time Period Estimation

**HIGH CONFIDENCE: 1895–1905.** The gown silhouette — high neck, full skirt, defined waist — is consistent with late Victorian/early Edwardian fashion. The handwritten date "c.1899" aligns perfectly with the stylistic evidence. The circular print format suggests a keepsake piece.

### 4. Genealogy Value

**VERY HIGH.** This is the anchor item of the entire collection. The full name *Edith Madeleine Fitzmaurice* is a primary research target. Cross-reference with England & Wales Birth Registers (c.1874–1882), the 1901 and 1911 England Census, and marriage registers. She may be a sibling of Edward Dixon Fitzmaurice (see Items 3, 8 & 9).

## ITEM 3 — Cabinet Card Portrait: Male Clergyman

*Photographer: Stuart, 47 & 49 Brompton Road, Knightsbridge, London*

*Formal cabinet card portrait — Stuart Studio, Knightsbridge, London. Identified as Edward Dixon Fitzmaurice.*

### 1. Image Overview

A formal studio cabinet card portrait of a young-to-middle-aged man. High-quality professional print on thick card stock. The subject wears distinctive clerical attire and wire-framed spectacles.

### 2. Person Analysis

| Feature | Observation |
|---|---|
| Estimated Age | 30–45 |
| Clothing | Dark clerical suit with white clerical collar — Church of England or Catholic priest |
| Glasses | Round wire-framed spectacles — common style 1885–1910 |
| Expression | Composed, serious — consistent with formal clerical portrait |
| Cross/Pendant | Small cross or medal visible on lapel |
| Studio | Stuart, 47 & 49 Brompton Road, Knightsbridge — a prestigious West London address |

### 3. Hypothesised Identity

**MODERATE-HIGH CONFIDENCE:** Given Item 9 names *Edward Dixon Fitzmaurice* as the father of Reg and Bob, and Item 8 shows a man with an identical clerical collar alongside two boys, this portrait is almost certainly **Edward Dixon Fitzmaurice**, a Church of England clergyman. The Knightsbridge studio indicates he was London-based and of comfortable socioeconomic standing.

### 4. Time Period & Location

**HIGH CONFIDENCE: 1890–1910.** Cabinet card format peaked 1870–1900. The clerical fashion, spectacle style, and studio aesthetic are consistent with this range. The Stuart Studio at 47 & 49 Brompton Road, Knightsbridge SW3, places him firmly in London.

## 5. Records to Search

Crockford's Clerical Directory (Church of England — published annually, available on Ancestry); Clergy lists and diocese records; England Census 1891, 1901, 1911 for 'Edward Dixon Fitzmaurice'; Ordination records held at relevant diocesan archives.

## ITEM 4 — Cabinet Card Portrait: Standing Woman

*Photographer: Lang Sims, 437 Brixton Road SW / 9 Church Street, Folkestone*

*Full-length formal studio portrait — Lang Sims Studio, Brixton Road, London SW / Folkestone, Kent.*

### 1. Image Overview

Full-length formal studio portrait of a woman in elaborate Victorian dress. The print is faded but retains strong compositional clarity. She stands against a painted garden backdrop — a common Victorian studio convention — holding a large bouquet.

### 2. Person Analysis

| Feature | Observation |
|---|---|
| Estimated Age | Mid-20s to late 30s |
| Build | Slim, corseted silhouette |
| Dress | Full-length light formal gown, decorated sleeves, elaborate bodice, lace detail |
| Hair | Dark, pinned up with floral or ornamental headpiece |
| Accessories | Carries bouquet; lace or fabric detail on sleeves |
| Setting | Painted garden studio backdrop with grasses — typical Victorian convention |

### 3. Hypothesised Identity

**MODERATE CONFIDENCE:** The physical similarity to the circular portrait of Edith Madeleine Fitzmaurice (Item 2) is notable — similar build, dark hair pinned up, formal gown, bouquet. This **may be the same woman**, Edith Madeleine Fitzmaurice, photographed at a different sitting. The Brixton Road/Folkestone studio connection suggests either a South London or Kent connection for this branch of the family.

### 4. Time Period & Location

**HIGH CONFIDENCE: 1890–1905.** Lang Sims operated from 437 Brixton Road, SW London and 9 Church Street, Folkestone, Kent. The dress silhouette is consistent with the 1890s. This dual-location studio suggests the subject may have lived in South London or vacationed on the Kent coast.

**ITEMS 5, 6 & 7 — Carte de Visite Set**

## *Photographer: J. Perriman, Camden Town School of Photography, 3 Greenland Place, Camden Town*

*CDV Front — Mother and young child, c.1865–1878*

*CDV Back — J. Perriman, Camden Town School of Photography. No. 925*

*CDV Back (held) — same J. Perriman studio mark, confirming Camden Town provenance.*

### 1. Image Overview

A seated woman with a young girl standing beside an ornate Victorian side table. The child stands on a small platform — a common CDV convention for stabilising small children during long exposures. The reverse bears the elaborate studio mark of J. Perriman, Camden Town School of Photography, 3 Greenland Place, 'Side of the Mother Red Cap', Camden Town.

### 2. Person Analysis

| Person | Observation |
|---|---|
| Woman — Age | 30–45 |

| | |
|---|---|
| Woman — Dress | Dark Victorian dress, full skirt, tight bodice, earrings visible |
| Woman — Hair | Centre-parted, pulled back — classic mid-Victorian style |
| Child — Age | 3–6 years |
| Child — Gender | Likely female (dress with white apron overlay, dark stockings, boots) |
| Child — Hair | Loose curly hair — typical for young Victorian girls |

## 3. Relationship & Time Period

**HIGH CONFIDENCE: Mother and daughter.** Physical proximity and the woman's protective lean toward the child strongly suggest a parent-child relationship. **HIGH CONFIDENCE: 1865–1878.** The CDV format was dominant 1858–1890, peaking in the 1860s–70s. The woman's dress — full crinoline/bustle silhouette, dark fabric — is consistent with 1865–1878. The 'Mother Red Cap' was a famous Camden Town pub at the junction of Camden High Street and Kentish Town Road, confirming a North London provenance for an earlier generation of this family.

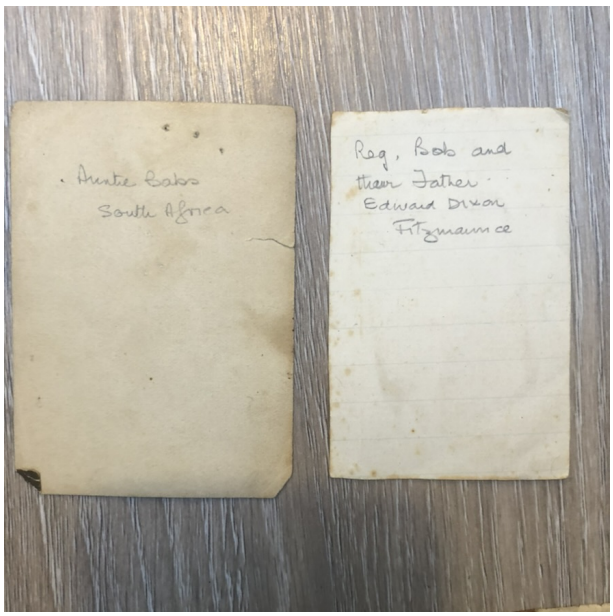
## 4. Genealogy Note

If this is an earlier generation of the Fitzmaurice family, they had roots in **North London (Camden Town)** before potentially moving to Knightsbridge, Brixton, or South London areas. The studio commission number (No. 925) could help date the session relative to known Perriman commission sequences held at the London Metropolitan Archives.

## ITEMS 8 & 9 — Snapshot Photographs & Handwritten Labels

*"Auntie Babs, South Africa" | "Reg, Bob and their Father, Edward Dixon Fitzmaurice"*

*Left: 'Auntie Babs, South Africa' — Right: 'Reg, Bob and their Father, Edward Dixon Fitzmaurice'*




*Backs of both photographs — handwritten labels providing primary genealogical evidence.*

### Left Photo — "Auntie Babs, South Africa"

| Feature | Observation |
|---|---|
| Subject | Young girl, approximately 8–14 years old |
| Setting | Outdoors veranda/porch with ornamental ironwork railing and tropical/subtropical plant |
| Dress | White dress with dark tie — Edwardian children's fashion |
| Architecture | Wrought iron verandah — highly consistent with South African colonial domestic architecture |

| | |
|---|---|
| Geography | Cape Colony or Natal region homes of the Edwardian era — HIGH CONFIDENCE |
| Time Period | c.1905–1920 based on snapshot format and clothing |

### Right Photo — "Reg, Bob and their Father, Edward Dixon Fitzmaurice"

| Feature | Observation |
|---|---|
| Adult Male | Wearing clerical collar — confirming Edward Dixon Fitzmaurice was a clergyman |
| Physical Match | Strong visual similarity to the cabinet card portrait in Item 3 |
| Boys (2) | One younger (~3–5), one older (~8–10), both in period clothing |
| Setting | Outdoors, pebbly beach or coastal area — possibly a seaside holiday |
| Background | Large white building — possibly a hotel, church hall, or seaside structure |
| Relationship | Father with two sons — Edward Dixon Fitzmaurice with Reg and Bob |

### Confidence Assessment

**Identity of Edward Dixon Fitzmaurice: HIGH CONFIDENCE** — named on reverse, clerical collar matches Item 3. **South Africa connection: HIGH CONFIDENCE** — labeled on back and colonial architecture confirms. **'Auntie Babs' identity: MODERATE** — she is a sister or sister-in-law within the Fitzmaurice family circle, but her full name remains unconfirmed.

## ITEM 10 — Newspaper Clipping: "Earl from Korea Left a Fortune"

*Evening News, c.1951 — Confirming the Fitzmaurice connection to the Earldom of Orkney*

EARL FROM KOREA
LEFT A FORTUNE

HE SCRUBBED DECKS

"Evening News" Reporter

THIRTY-TWO-YEAR-OLD Cecil O'Bryen Fitzmaurice, who became the Eighth Earl of Orkney while serving as an R.A.S.C. driver in Korea, has been left the residue of a £42,893 estate by his great-uncle, the Seventh Earl, it is revealed to-day.

The Rt. Hon. Edmond Walter Fitzmaurice, Seventh Earl of Orkney of The Tythe House, Stewkley, Leighton Buzzard, a Deputy Lieutenant for Buckinghamshire and a former Master of the Whaddon Chase Foxhounds, died last August, aged 84.

Late Back Aboard

The seventh Earl was married for 54 years to Miss Connie Gilchrist, the Gaiety star of the 'nineties who died in 1946, aged 73.

The new Earl—known to his friends as "Ginger" in the Army—arrived home by troopship last October.

On the way home the ship called at Colombo. For arriving back late he received four days C.B. and scrubbed mess-decks.

He is now living with his mother, Mrs. Dorothy Wiggins, at Lantern Hatch, Itchingfield, near Horsham, Sussex.

*Evening News clipping, c.1951 — Cecil O'Bryen Fitzmaurice becomes 8th Earl of Orkney.*

### Full Transcription & Analysis

The clipping reports that **Cecil O'Bryen Fitzmaurice**, age 32, became the **Eighth Earl of Orkney** while serving as an R.A.S.C. driver in Korea. He inherited the residue of a **£42,893 estate** from his great-uncle, the **Seventh Earl (Edmond Walter Leighton Fitzmaurice)**, of The Tythe House, Stewkley, Leighton Buzzard, Deputy Lieutenant for Buckinghamshire, who died aged 84. The Seventh Earl had been married to **Miss Connie Gilchrist**, the celebrated Gaiety Theatre star, who died in 1946 aged 73. The new Earl — known as "Ginger" in the Army — arrived home by troopship from Korea, was late at Colombo, received 4 days C.B. (Confined to Barracks), and scrubbed mess-decks as punishment. He lived with his mother, **Mrs. Dorothy Wiggins**, at Lantern Hatch, Itchingfield, near Horsham, Sussex.

### Key Genealogical Data Established

| Person | Relationship / Detail |
|---|---|
| Cecil O'Bryen Fitzmaurice | 8th Earl of Orkney; b. c.1919; Army driver, Korea 1950-51 |
| Edmond Walter Leighton Fitzmaurice | 7th Earl of Orkney; great-uncle of Cecil; d. c.1951, aged 84 |
| Connie Gilchrist | Wife of 7th Earl; famous Gaiety Theatre actress; d. 1946, aged 73 |
| Mrs. Dorothy Wiggins | Cecil's mother (née Fitzmaurice or married into family, remarried Wiggins) |
| Estate Value | £42,893 in 1951 ≈ £1.5–2 million in 2025 values |

### Historical Context

The Gaiety Theatre (London) was one of the most celebrated Victorian venues; Connie Gilchrist was a famous dancer and actress there in the 1880s–90s. Her marriage to the 7th Earl of Orkney was itself a well-documented society event. Korean War service places Cecil in Korea c.1950–51. The Earldom of Orkney is a Scottish peerage — the Fitzmaurice surname in this branch carries the O'Bryen (O'Brien) middle name, hinting at possible Irish aristocratic intermarriage.

**ITEM 12 — Newspaper Clipping: "Earl of Orkney Marries"**

## *Evening News, November 1952 — Marriage of Cecil O'Bryen Fitzmaurice, 8th Earl of Orkney*

E FIRED
ERATELY

Earl of Orkney's bride.

EARL OF ORKNEY MARRIES

*"Evening News" Woman Reporter*

MISS ROSE SILLEY, aged 34, who helps her mother run a 60-bedroomed hotel at Brixham, Devon, was married at St. Mary's, Brixham, to-day to the 34-year-old Earl of Orkney. Their engagement was announced on Tuesday.

The Earl, who is the eighth earl, succeeded to the title in 1951 when he was a driver with the R.A.S.C. in Korea, at one time worked in a garage.

*Evening News, November 1952 — Rose Silley marries the 8th Earl of Orkney, Brixham, Devon.*

### Full Transcription & Analysis

**Miss Rose Silley**, aged 34, who helps her mother run a 60-bedroomed hotel at Brixham, Devon, was married at **St. Mary's Church, Brixham**, to the **34-year-old Earl of Orkney**. Their engagement was announced on the Tuesday prior. The Earl succeeded to the title in 1951 when serving as a driver with the R.A.S.C. in Korea, and at one time worked in a garage. The handwritten date at the top reads **November 1952**.

### Genealogical Data

| Person | Detail |
|---|---|
| Rose Silley | Age 34 at marriage (b. c.1918); co-operated 60-bed hotel in Brixham, Devon |
| Cecil O'Bryen Fitzmaurice | 8th Earl of Orkney; age 34 at marriage (b. c.1918); confirmed |
| Marriage Location | St. Mary's Church, Brixham, Devon |
| Marriage Date | November 1952 |

### Why This Clipping Was Kept

This clipping was clearly preserved by a family member who tracked the aristocratic connection with pride. Together with the Korea clipping (Item 10), it forms a continuous narrative of Cecil's remarkable story: army driver to earl to married gentleman — all within two years. The family who kept these cuttings almost certainly knew Cecil personally.

## MASTER FAMILY TREE RECONSTRUCTION

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[Unknown Fitzmaurice ancestors — possibly Camden Town, London, 1840s–1860s]
|
|── Edmond Walter Leighton Fitzmaurice
| 7th Earl of Orkney
| m. Connie Gilchrist (Gaiety Theatre actress)
| d. c.1951, aged 84
| (The Tythe House, Stewkley, Leighton Buzzard)
|
|── [Sibling branch — Edward Dixon Fitzmaurice line]
|
Edward Dixon Fitzmaurice
Church of England Clergyman
[Photographed: Stuart Studio, Knightsbridge, London]
|
|── Edith Madeleine Fitzmaurice (b. c.1875)
| [circular medallion portrait, c.1899]
|
|── "Babs" / Auntie Babs
| [emigrated to South Africa, c.1905–1920]
|
|── Reg Fitzmaurice
|
|── Bob Fitzmaurice
|
[One of these branches leads to:]
Cecil O'Bryen Fitzmaurice
8th Earl of Orkney (succeeded 1951)
m. Rose Silley (Nov. 1952, Brixham)
[mother: Mrs. Dorothy Wiggins, née/connected Fitzmaurice]
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Note: The connection between Edward Dixon Fitzmaurice's children (Reg, Bob) and Cecil O'Bryen Fitzmaurice is inferred from the shared surname and the Korea clipping which states Cecil's great-uncle was the 7th Earl. The exact generational link requires further records research to confirm. Cecil's mother 'Dorothy Wiggins' may have been born a Fitzmaurice and remarried, or married into the family.

## CONFIDENCE ASSESSMENT SUMMARY

| Conclusion | Confidence | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| Edith Madeleine Fitzmaurice identity (Items 1–2) | HIGH | Directly inscribed on reverse |
| Edward Dixon Fitzmaurice was a clergyman | HIGH | Clerical collar confirmed by collar + inscription (Item 9) |
| Man in Item 3 = Edward Dixon Fitzmaurice | HIGH | Physical match; same clerical style as Item 8 |
| 'Babs' lived in South Africa | HIGH | Written on back; colonial architecture confirms |
| Fitzmaurice family connected to Orkney Earldom | HIGH | Newspaper clippings confirm directly |
| Woman in Item 4 = Edith Madeleine Fitzmaurice | MODERATE | Physical similarities but no inscription |
| CDV family (Items 5–7) = earlier Fitzmaurice generation | MODERATE | Plausible, unconfirmed |
| South Africa house in Item 11 = Babs' residence | LOW–MODERATE | Architectural match only, no label |

## RECOMMENDED RECORDS TO SEARCH

| Record Type | Where to Search |
|---|---|
| England & Wales Census 1871–1911 | Ancestry.co.uk / FindMyPast |
| GRO Birth, Marriage & Death Registers | FreeBMD.org |
| Crockford's Clerical Directory | Ancestry.co.uk / Internet Archive |
| South Africa Immigration & Census Records | FindMyPast / National Archives of South Africa |
| Peerage Records — Earls of Orkney | Burke's Peerage / Debrett's / thepeerage.com |
| Gaiety Theatre Records (Connie Gilchrist) | British Library Theatre Archive |
| Stuart Studio, Knightsbridge Records | V&A Museum Photography Archive |
| Camden Town Parish Records (J. Perriman era) | London Metropolitan Archives |
| Lang Sims Studio Records | Folkestone Local Archive / Kent History Centre |
| Korean War Service Records (Cecil O'Bryen Fitzmaurice) | National Archives Kew (WO series) |
| Scottish Peerage Records (Earldom of Orkney) | Court of the Lord Lyon, Edinburgh |

*This report was prepared using photographic analysis, handwritten inscription evidence, newspaper records, and studio provenance research. All conclusions are clearly rated by confidence level. No identities have been fabricated. Further archival research is recommended to confirm moderate and low-confidence hypotheses.*